# CHUKWUMA ZIKORA

**DevOps / Platform Engineer**

Anambra, Nigeria · +234 703 131 0606 · chukwuma.zikora@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/chukwumazikora · github.com/chukwumaijem · chukwumaijem.github.io

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps and Platform Engineer with 10+ years of software engineering experience, currently focused on infrastructure automation, CI/CD pipeline design, cloud architecture, and container orchestration. Proven record designing and operating deployment infrastructure for healthcare-grade SaaS systems. Operate a self-hosted homelab covering Swarm orchestration, observability, and deny-by-default egress security. Open to DevOps / Platform / SRE roles.

## CORE SKILLS

| | |
|---|---|
| **Containers & Orchestration** | Docker, Docker Swarm, Kubernetes, Helm, kubeadm |
| **CI/CD & Automation** | GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, CircleCI, Ansible, Vagrant |
| **Cloud & Infrastructure** | AWS (Lambda, API Gateway), Proxmox, Linux (Ubuntu) |
| **Observability** | Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, Grafana Alloy, cAdvisor |
| **Application Development** | React.js, Next.js, Node.js, NestJS, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, APIs |

## INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab and platform labs: github.com/chukwumaijem/playground-devops

### Self-Hosted Platform Homelab - Proxmox + Swarm + Observability

2025 - Present

*Stack: Proxmox, Docker Swarm, Caddy Docker Proxy, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, Alloy*

- Built a multi-VM Proxmox homelab: application Swarm cluster plus a dedicated monitoring VM, with overlay networks separating proxy, backend, and logging traffic.
- Deployed multi-stack microservices with label-driven HTTPS routing via Caddy Docker Proxy (Cloudflare DNS / Let's Encrypt) - no manual proxy rewrites per service.
- Stood up Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, and Alertmanager with provisioned dashboards, container down/restart alerts, and Alloy shipping app-node logs to the monitoring VM.

### Deny-by-Default Container Egress Gateway

2025 - Present

*Stack: Ansible, Squid, iptables (DOCKER-USER), Docker Swarm*

- Designed deny-by-default container egress: direct internet access is dropped; only traffic via a host Squid proxy (HTTP_PR0XY) is allowed.
- Automated install and hardening with Ansible - Squid, domain allowlists, `iptables-persistent`, and DOCKER-USER drop rules on the default-route interface.
- Validated with a Swarm demo: compliant services succeed on allowlisted hosts; rogue containers that bypass the proxy fail.

### Kubernetes Multi-Service Packaging with Helm

2025 - Present

*Stack: Kubernetes (Minikube, MicroK8s), Helm, Docker Voting App*

- Packaged a multi-tier voting application as Helm charts - both a single umbrella chart and per-service charts.
- Practised chart structure, Go templating, values overrides, and install/upgrade workflows for consistent multi-environment deploys.
- Complements hands-on cluster work with Minikube, MicroK8s, and kubeadm (multi-node).

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**Senior Software Engineer | ShiftHealth** July 2020 - Present

Remote | Healthcare automation platform (Zapier-style integration engine)

- Designed and built CI/CD pipeline infrastructure using GitHub Actions and Docker, reducing deployment cycle time and eliminating manual deployment errors across a multi-environment healthcare platform.
- Migrated critical system components from traditional server infrastructure to AWS Serverless (Lambda, API Gateway), improving cost-efficiency and enabling elastic scaling for variable workloads.
- Designed and implemented microservices architecture for the team and user management system, improving service isolation, scalability, and independent deployability.
- Built and maintained healthcare system connectors and integration workflows for automated data exchange between clinical and administrative platforms.
- Currently responsible for deployment supervision across fully automated infrastructure; all deployment pipelines are self-designed and self-maintained.

**Software Engineer | Unbird** July 2019 - June 2020

Remote

- Developed a real-time notification system using WebSockets and implemented granular team permission controls for secure, role-scoped access across multi-tenant workspaces.

**Freelance JavaScript Developer | Kwhen** September 2017 - June 2019

Remote | Event curation platform

- Integrated multiple third-party event partner APIs and implemented search/filter logic to expand content coverage and improve event discovery.

## INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS - BLOCKQUEUE SYSTEMS LTD

Founder of BlockQueue Systems Limited. Built and shipped two production SaaS platforms as sole or lead engineer, owning product architecture, infrastructure design, and cloud deployment.

**Lead Engineer - Property Governors** 2025 - Present

propertygovernors.com *Stack: Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL · Infra & deployment owned end-to-end*

- Designed and managed all cloud infrastructure and deployment pipelines for a live multi-sided property management SaaS serving users across Nigeria.

**Lead Engineer - FirmLyt** 2024 - Present

firmlyt.com *Stack: Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker*

- Handled end-to-end infrastructure design, CI/CD setup, and cloud deployment on AWS for a legal practice management SaaS.

## OPEN SOURCE - GITHUB.COM/BLOCKQUEUE

Publishes self-hostable infrastructure tooling under the BlockQueue organisation on GitHub.

**Notifier** 2025 - Present

github.com/blockqueue/notifier *TypeScript | Apache-2.0 | Docker*

- Self-hostable email orchestration microservice with dual auth (API key + HMAC), rate limiting, YAML-driven config, and Docker deployment.

**BQ Queue** 2026 - Present

github.com/blockqueue/bq-queue *TypeScript | Apache-2.0 | Docker Compose*

- Self-hostable PostgreSQL-backed job queue and signed HTTP webhook delivery service with idempotency guarantees and full Docker Compose setup.

## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

**Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka** - B.Sc. Computer Science, Second Class Honours (Upper Division)

**Udacity** - Cloud DevOps Engineering Nanodegree July 2022